

Lonza Biotechnologist 1 Interview Preparation Guide

Interview Date: Thursday, June 5, 2025 | 1:00 PM – 3:00 PM BST

Location: Meeting Room Slough 234-2 Chestnut, 234 Bath Rd, Slough SL1 4DX

1. Interview Logistics & Key Details

- **Date & Time:**
 - Thursday, June 5, 2025
 - 1:00 PM – 3:00 PM (BST)
- **Format:**
 - Onsite interview (2 hours total)
 - Includes a short practical assessment
- **Interviewers:**
 - Tara Gorman (Associate Director)
 - Gemma Lyon (Associate Director; Hiring Manager)
 - Ashley Davidson (Technical Trainer)
- **Arrival Instructions:**
 - **Report to B234 Reception** at Lonza Slough Office.
 - **Arrival Time:** Arrive 10 – 15 minutes early (target 12:45 PM).
 - **Check-In:** Bring a government-issued photo ID (passport or driver's license) and let reception know you're meeting Gemma Lyon.
 - **Parking:** Space reserved at B234 Space 16 for vehicle registration **LY55 LUR**. Allow extra time for parking.
 - **Accessibility:** If you require any accommodations (mobility, visual, or auditory), email Ritika Anand (ritika.anand@lonza.com) at least 48 hours beforehand.

2. Role Overview & Company Context

2.1 About Lonza

- **Global Leader:**
 - Life sciences company operating across five continents.
 - Provides Contract Development & Manufacturing Organization (CDMO) services for pharmaceuticals, biotechnology, and nutrition.
- **Core Focus Areas:**
 - Biologics (ADCs, monoclonal antibodies, protein therapeutics)
 - Cell & Gene Therapy (CGT)
 - mRNA Vaccines
 - Small Molecules
- **Recent Investments & Partnerships:**
 - **2024 mRNA Facility (Portsmouth, UK):** £100 million + investment for commercial-scale mRNA production (e.g., Moderna vaccines).
 - **2024 Swiss Bioscience Campus (Basel):** CHF 500 million facility for CGT manufacturing (CAR-T therapies).
 - **2023 Synaffix Acquisition:** Enhances ADC (antibody-drug conjugate) platform.
 - Ongoing collaboration with Moderna for COVID-19 and flu vaccines.
 - Partnership with CRISPR Therapeutics for exa-cel (Casgevy).
- **Culture & Values:**
 - Collaboration, continuous improvement, and ethical manufacturing

– Inclusive, diverse workplace with a shared responsibility to improve patient lives and protect the environment

2.2 Biotechnologist 1 Role (Job Ref: R66850)

- **Contract:**

- 12-month fixed-term contract, 37.5 hours/week
- Based at Lonza's Slough, UK manufacturing facility

- **Role Purpose:**

- **Learn & Apply GMP Standards:** Gain hands-on experience in Good Manufacturing Practice.
- **Progressive Autonomy:** Start with supervised tasks (adhering to SOPs, assisting with documentation), then move to independent execution.
- **Support Quality Systems:** Own area processes in upstream/downstream bioprocessing, maintain documentation, and help drive continuous improvement.

- **Key Responsibilities:**

- **GMP-Compliant Production:** Operate bioreactors, perform purification steps, assist with buffer/media preparation, and support aseptic work.
- **Documentation & Quality Systems:** Maintain batch records, log deviations, initiate CAPAs, and ensure traceability (ALCOA+ principles).
- **Equipment & Area Ownership:** Operate/clean lab equipment, perform routine maintenance checks, ensure area cleanliness.
- **Continuous Improvement:** Identify process bottlenecks, propose efficiency gains, and participate in lean or Six Sigma initiatives.

- **What Lonza Offers:**

- Agile career progression in a dynamic, innovative environment
- Competitive compensation, benefits, and hands-on training
- An inclusive, ethical workplace that values high performance and continuous learning

2.3 What Lonza Seeks in You

- **Essential Skills & Experience:**

- Background in biotechnology (molecular biology, virology, cell culture)
- Familiarity with GMP/ISO environments (ISO 13485, ISO 17025)
- Strong Excel proficiency, attention to detail, and excellent organizational skills
- Teamwork, communication, and problem-solving abilities
- Proactive, continuous improvement mindset

- **Desirable Traits:**

- Experience with CE-marked reagent production, PCR/ELISA, or viral diagnostics
- Hands-on experience in BSL-2 or BSL-3 containment laboratories
- Ability to thrive under pressure and adapt to shifting priorities

3. Your Professional Background (Key Selling Points)

Use these highlights to demonstrate alignment with the Biotechnologist 1 requirements:

1. **15 Years in Molecular Biology & Virology**

- a. **NIBSC (Mar 2013 – Aug 2022):**

- Led WHO International Standardisation projects for HSV, HIV-2, HAV, and WNV.

- Produced CE-marked IVD reagents under ISO 13485.
- Conducted stability/potency testing under ISO 17025.
- Coordinated 30+ global labs, authored WHO reports, and presented at expert committees.

b. Anthony Nolan (Aug 2023 – Feb 2024):

- Performed virological screening using Dynex and Immunocor Echo platforms under UKAS standards.
- Troubleshoot diagnostic instruments and optimized protocols, improving throughput and data quality.

c. **UKHSA (Jan 2010 – Jan 2011):** RT-qPCR for influenza diagnostics.

d. **NHS Blood Transplant (Nov 2009 – Jan 2010):** HLA typing and GMP quality control.

e. **Covance (May 2007 – Feb 2008):** RT-qPCR for regulatory studies (GLP/GMP).

2. Regulatory & Quality Expertise

- a. Deep knowledge of ISO 13485 (CE-marked IVDs) and ISO 17025 (diagnostic testing).
- b. Hands-on with IVDR transition: revised 10+ SOPs, ensured traceability, prepared for audits.
- c. Skilled in deviation/CAPA management, root-cause analysis, and internal audit participation.

3. Technical Proficiency

- a. **PCR Platforms:** Roche Cobas 6800, Liaison XL, LightCycler 480, ABI 7500/7900, dd-PCR.
- b. **Extraction Systems:** QIAcube, MagNaPure, Biomerieux EasyMag, QIAasymphony.
- c. **Cell Culture & Biocontainment:** BSL-2/BSL-3 work—virus propagation, inactivation, aseptic technique, liquid nitrogen storage.
- d. **Data Tools:** Prism, Minitab, CombiStats, Excel, LIMS.

4. Collaboration & Leadership

- a. Coordinated cross-functional WHO standardisation studies with 30+ international labs.
- b. Negotiated protocols and shared resources (e.g., with Royal Free Hospital) to complete commutability evaluations on time.
- c. Mentored junior scientists, delivered training on SOPs and new instrumentation.

5. Continuous Improvement Mindset

- a. Redesigned commutability studies via EQA integration—collected 300+ data points at zero additional cost.
- b. Reduced PCR turnaround times by 20% through assay optimization.
- c. Implemented pH monitoring alarms and temperature data logging to safeguard reagent stability.

4. 30-Second Elevator Pitch

“I’m a molecular biologist with over 15 years of experience in GMP-regulated labs, specializing in virology, diagnostics, and bioprocessing. At NIBSC, I led WHO International Standard projects—producing CE-marked reagents under ISO 13485 and coordinating 30+ global labs to validate viral reference materials. I also optimized PCR assays, reducing turnaround times by 20%. Most recently, at Anthony Nolan, I improved virological screening protocols under UKAS standards. I thrive on precision, continuous improvement, and teamwork, and I’m excited to bring my technical and regulatory expertise to Lonza’s innovative work in mRNA vaccines and biologics at Slough.”

5. Likely Interview Questions & Model Answers

Tip: Use the **STAR** (Situation, Task, Action, Result) framework for behavioral questions. Keep technical responses concise and aligned to Lonza's GMP/ISO environment.

5.1 “Tell me about yourself.” (1–2 minutes)

“I’m a molecular biologist with 15 years of experience in virology, diagnostics, and bioprocessing—key areas for Lonza’s Biotechnologist 1 role. At NIBSC, I led WHO International Standard projects, produced CE-marked reagents under ISO 13485, and performed batch release testing under ISO 17025 using Roche Cobas 6800 and LightCycler 480. I coordinated 30+ global labs to validate reference materials (e.g., HSV, HIV-2, HAV, WNV), authored WHO reports, and presented findings at expert committees and global conferences eg ECMID and ESCV. I also spearheaded a commutability study improvement, integrating EQA providers to collect 300+ data points cost-effectively. More recently, at Anthony Nolan, I optimized Dynex and Immunocor Echo protocols to meet UKAS standards, boosting lab throughput. My strengths lie in meticulous documentation, deviation/CAPA management, and cross-functional collaboration. I’m excited to apply these skills to Lonza’s Slough facility, supporting GMP manufacturing and driving continuous improvement.”

5.2 “What do you know about Lonza and this Biotechnologist 1 role?” (1–2 minutes)

“Lonza is a global life sciences leader, providing CDMO services for biologics, cell & gene therapies, mRNA vaccines and small drug molecules. Your recent £100 million mRNA facility in Portsmouth and CGT campus in Basel and investment into ADC and CRISPR based therapeutics demonstrate your commitment to cutting-edge manufacturing. The Slough site focuses on biologics production—leveraging Stainless steel bioreactors for flexibility and efficiency. The Biotechnologist 1 role involves hands-on GMP manufacturing: performing upstream/downstream processes, maintaining batch records, logging deviations, and contributing to continuous improvement. My background—producing CE-marked IVDs under ISO 13485 at NIBSC and conducting GMP final release safety batch testing—directly aligns with these responsibilities. I admire Lonza’s ethical, innovation-driven culture, and I’m eager to contribute my regulatory expertise, technical skills, and problem-solving mindset to your team efforts to improve patient lives.”

5.3 “Why are you interested in this role at Lonza?” (1 minute)

“Lonza’s leadership in biomanufacturing, especially ADCs, mRNA vaccines and CGTs, is inspiring. My 15 years in GMP-regulated labs—leading WHO projects and producing CE-marked reagents—directly align with the Biotechnologist 1 role’s focus on quality systems, documentation, and hands-on processes. My continuous improvement initiatives, like gathering 300+ commutability data points at zero cost, reflect the innovation Lonza values. I’m particularly excited by your recent investments in single-use bioreactors and your collaborations with Moderna and CRISPR Therapeutics. I’m confident that my technical expertise, regulatory knowledge, and collaborative approach will contribute to Lonza’s mission to deliver high-quality, world-changing products from the Slough facility.”

5.4 What are your three key strengths and one area for development?

“My three key strengths are:

1. **Biotechnology Experience & Attention to Detail:** At NIBSC, I streamlined PCR assays—boosting throughput while maintaining specificity. This shows my ability to spot and address small details that have big impacts.

2. **Quality Systems & Documentation:** I've managed ISO 13485/ISO 17025 compliance, handled deviations and CAPAs, and updated SOPs during an IVDR transition—always keeping records audit-ready and well organized.
3. **Teamwork & Collaboration:** When Royal Free Hospital's lab was understaffed for a WHO study, I set up weekly check-ins, co-created a lean protocol, and delivered robust data on schedule. That demonstrates both drive for results and an ability to work closely with diverse teams.

Areas for development and improvements; I feel being very technically analytically minded, I find sometimes can be difficult to communicate in manner tailored to audience, flu presentation delivered to team who had subject matter expertise understood technical language and resulted in productive debate but delivering to wider audience in division even though I adjusted language I feel wasn't understood well as it didn't result in as productive a discussion.

5.5 “Give an example of cross-functional teamwork.” (1–2 minutes)

“In a WHO hCMV standardisation study at NIBSC, the Royal Free Hospital's lab needed to participate but had limited staff. I initiated weekly sync calls, co-designed a streamlined protocol that minimized their workload, and provided assay kits under MTA. I also liaised with their QA team to confirm compliance. By aligning incentives—showing how the data would improve their EQA programs—we secured their buy-in. The project completed on schedule, delivering a robust dataset that contributed to WHO's published standard. This experience reinforced my ability to build relationships, negotiate resources, and deliver high-quality scientific output—exactly what Lonza seeks for cross-functional collaboration.”

5.6 “Describe a time you improved a process.” (1 minute)

“At NIBSC, traditional commutability studies were limited to small sample sizes, reducing statistical power. I proposed integrating reference materials into an existing EQA scheme, negotiating with providers to distribute our material alongside their panels. This gathered 300+ data points from multiple labs at no extra cost or burden. I drafted the protocol, negotiated business agreements, and trained collaborating labs. After a successful HSV pilot, this approach was adopted for other viral standards. The outcome: richer datasets, improved assay robustness, and a cost-effective model. Lonza values such continuous improvement and resource efficiency—qualities I'll bring to your team.”

5.7 “How would you resolve a conflict at work?” (1 minute)

“At NIBSC, two colleagues disagreed on data interpretation during an HSV standardisation study, each insisting their method was best. I scheduled a group meeting, listened to both sides, and invited our in-house biostatistician to provide objective statistical analysis. By focusing on data and bringing everyone to the same page, we reached consensus and finalized a protocol that satisfied both parties. My approach is to address conflicts early, encourage open dialogue, and involve a neutral expert if needed—always keeping our shared goal of GMP compliance and project success in mind. At Lonza, I'd apply this same approach to maintain team cohesion and quality.”

5.8 “Describe your hands-on experience with biotech processes like PCR or assay validation.” (1–2 minutes)

“Over 15 years, I've validated and executed PCR assays in GMP and ISO settings. At NIBSC, I led batch release testing of CE-marked IVD reagents using Roche Cobas 6800 RT-qPCR. I optimized a multiplex HBV/HCV assay: refined primer/probe concentrations, adjusted cycling conditions, and

reduced run time by 20% while maintaining >99.9% specificity. In BSL-3 labs, I propagated HIV-2 for WHO standards, following strict aseptic protocols and validated viral inactivation steps. At Anthony Nolan, I troubleshooted Dynex immunoassay platforms, improving throughput by standardizing buffers and troubleshooting hardware errors. I also authored SOPs, trained lab staff, and ensured all methods complied with UKAS and ISO requirements. These experiences equip me to handle Lonza's GMP bioprocessing and assay validation needs."

5.9 "How do you ensure GMP compliance in your work?" (1 minute)

"GMP is integral to everything I do. At NIBSC, I followed ALCOA+ principles—ensuring data is Attributable, Legible, Contemporaneous, Original, and Accurate, plus Complete, Consistent, Enduring, and Available. For example, when I noticed Ct values drifting during a Cobas 6800 run (due to an expired reagent), I immediately quarantined the batch, documented the deviation, and collaborated with QA to implement a CAPA: adding a pre-run positive control to detect reagent quality issues earlier. I revised 10+ SOPs to align with IVDR requirements, ensuring traceability for audits. I perform daily equipment calibration checks, review logbooks, and maintain meticulous records. My proactive approach to deviations and CAPA ensures Lonza's rigorous quality systems remain uncompromised."

5.10 "How do you maintain safety in containment labs?" (1 minute)

"Working with BSL-3 pathogens at NIBSC, I adhered to stringent PPE protocols—double gloves, respiratory protection, and gowns—while following validated decontamination procedures (10 % bleach with 15 min contact time). Daily, I performed biosafety cabinet airflow checks, verified HEPA filter certifications, and logged all entries/exits. Once, I halted work when I noticed an expired certification sticker on a BSC; I immediately notified divisional resource manager for recertification, preventing potential aerosol exposure. I also led quarterly spill drills to keep the team prepared. This vigilant, proactive safety mindset aligns with Lonza's zero-incident culture in BSL-2/3 laboratories."

5.11 "What would you do in the event of a biological spill in the lab?" (1 minute)

"In my BSL-3 work at NIBSC, I managed a positive blood pack spill. First, I'd alert colleagues and evacuate non-essential personnel. Then, I'd don full PPE (gown, gloves, face shield, fit-tested respirator), quarantine the area, and contain the spill with absorbent mats. I'd apply a validated disinfectant (10 % bleach) with at least a 15-minute contact time and dispose of waste in biohazard bins. After cleanup, I'd document the incident as a GMP deviation, perform root-cause analysis (e.g., evaluating packaging stability or SOP adherence), and escalate to QA for CAPA. Finally, I'd lead a "lessons learned" debrief to update SOPs or training. This ensures alignment with Lonza's safety, GMP, and EHS standards."

6. Mock Practical Assessment & Correct Responses

Allocate roughly 100 minutes to simulate the 2-hour onsite window. Verbally walk through each step to demonstrate your reasoning and GMP mindset.

Task 1: SOP Interpretation & Deviation Identification (30 minutes)

Scenario

You receive an SOP excerpt for preparing 500 mL viral culture medium:

1. Wear gloves, lab coat, and safety goggles.
2. Sanitize workbench with 70 % ethanol.
3. Add 450 mL sterile PBS to a sterile graduated cylinder.

4. Weigh out 5 g peptone and add to PBS.
5. Mix until fully dissolved.
6. Adjust pH to 7.4 ± 0.1 with HCl or NaOH.
7. Bring final volume to 500 mL with sterile water.
8. Label, date, and sign the bottle; record batch number.

Observed Deviations:

- Technician skipped ethanol wipe (Step 2).
- Added 6 g peptone instead of 5 g (Step 4).
- Adjusted pH to 7.2 (out of 7.4 ± 0.1 spec; Step 6).
- Left batch number blank (Step 8).

Your Tasks & Model Responses

1. List all deviations from the SOP:

- a. No bench sanitization (Step 2).
- b. Peptone overweight by 1 g (Step 4).
- c. pH out of specification (7.2 vs. 7.4 ± 0.1 ; Step 6).
- d. Missing batch number (Step 8).

2. Immediate actions:

- a. Quarantine the medium—do not use or release.
- b. Alert your supervisor and QA immediately.
- c. Discard the incorrect medium as biohazard waste, after proper decontamination.
- d. Re-sanitize the bench thoroughly and prepare a fresh batch following the SOP exactly.

3. Documentation & escalation:

- a. Complete a Deviation/Incident Report, listing each deviation with timestamps and operator initials.
- b. Attach raw data: weigh scale log, pH meter printout.
- c. Notify QA for root-cause analysis and CAPA (corrective and preventive action).
- d. Update the technician's training record and schedule a refresher on SOP adherence if needed.

Tip: Emphasize ALCOA+ (Attributable, Legible, Contemporaneous, Original, Accurate + Complete, Consistent, Enduring, Available) when describing how you'd document each step.

Task 2: Batch Record Review & Calculation (20 minutes)

Scenario

A partial batch record for a cell-based assay specifies:

- **Target cell density:** 2×10^5 cells/mL
- **Plate format:** 6-well plate (2 mL medium per well)
- **Cell suspension concentration:** 4×10^6 cells/mL

Your Tasks & Model Responses

1. Calculate how much suspension to add per well:

- a. Required cells per well = $2 \text{ mL} \times 2 \times 10^5 \text{ cells/mL} = 4 \times 10^5 \text{ cells}$.
- b. At $4 \times 10^6 \text{ cells/mL}$, volume = $(4 \times 10^5) / (4 \times 10^6) = 0.1 \text{ mL}$ (100 μL) per well.

2. Describe how you'd verify accuracy on the bench:

- a. Pre-label pipette tips and wells.
- b. Use a calibrated 100 μL pipette.
- c. Perform a pipetting check: dispense 100 μL into a pre-weighed tube of water, then re-weigh to ensure $\sim 0.1 \text{ g}$.
- d. Visually confirm no air bubbles and consistent technique for each well.

3. Explain what you'd record in the batch record:

- "Added 100 μL of 4×10^6 cells/mL suspension to each well (final cell density = 2×10^5 cells/mL in 2 mL)."
- Record pipette ID, calibration date, operator initials, date, and time.
- Note any deviations or observations (e.g., cell clumping, viability).

Tip: Under GMP, accurate batch records are critical for traceability and audit readiness.

Task 3: Aseptic Technique & Contamination Control (20 minutes)

Scenario

Demonstrate how to set up a BSL-2 biosafety cabinet to thaw a frozen viral stock and prepare an assay plate.

Your Tasks & Model Responses

1. List steps in proper order:

- Don appropriate PPE: lab gown, gloves, face shield or goggles, mask.
- Disinfect the interior surfaces of the biosafety cabinet with 70 % ethanol; run airflow system for 5 minutes.
- Arrange all necessary sterile items inside: pipettes, tips, tubes, waste containers, assay plates.
- Thaw the frozen viral stock in a 37 °C water bath **outside** the cabinet (per SOP).
- Wipe the exterior of the viral stock vial with 70 % ethanol before placing it inside the cabinet.
- Finish thawing inside the cabinet (if SOP requires) or proceed to aliquot directly.
- Use sterile technique to aliquot virus into the assay plate wells.
- Seal the plate with adhesive film and transfer it to secondary containment for incubation.
- After completion, decontaminate all interior surfaces with a validated disinfectant (e.g., bleach followed by ethanol).
- Remove waste and log cabinet cleanup in the biosafety cabinet logbook.

2. Highlight three contamination-control best practices:

- Disinfect everything entering/exiting the cabinet:** Prevents cross-contamination.
- Minimize rapid hand/arm movements:** Maintains laminar airflow integrity.
- Change gloves frequently:** Especially after handling non-sterile items or spills.

3. Point out where QA checks would occur:

- Before Starting:** Verify the biosafety cabinet's certification sticker (date and signature visible).
- During Work:** Log operator name, date/time, and disinfection times in the cabinet's log.
- After Work:** Record final disinfection steps, note any spill incidents, and confirm filter status.

Tip: Verbalize ALCOA+ data entry (e.g., logging times, initials, disinfection details) to demonstrate your GMP mindset.

Task 4: CAPA & Root-Cause Analysis Write-Up (30 minutes)

Scenario

A Week 4 stability test on a CE-marked reagent fails its potency specification. Draft a root-cause analysis (RCA) and initial CAPA plan.

Your Tasks & Model Responses

1. Identify at least three possible root causes:

- a. **Inadequate buffer pH control** during formulation—pH drift may destabilize the reagent.
- b. **Cold-chain interruption** during storage or transport—temperature excursion could degrade potency.
- c. **Operator technique variance**—inconsistent mixing or inaccurate volume measurements resulting in concentration errors.

2. Propose corrective actions:

- a. Re-test buffer pH of retained samples and review lot records for pH logs; quarantine affected batch.
- b. Examine temperature data logs (data loggers) for the entire cold-chain; quarantine any product with temperature excursions.
- c. Retrain operators on the SOP for mixing, filling procedures, and handling; schedule hands-on competency assessments.

3. Outline preventive actions:

- a. Implement real-time pH monitoring with alarm notifications during formulation runs.
- b. Introduce continuous temperature data logging (with deviation alerts) for storage and shipping.
- c. Establish periodic, documented SOP refresher training for all operators, including a mixing and measurement checklist.

Tip: Structure your RCA/CAPA clearly, showing you can document impacts, notify QA, and track CAPA effectiveness over time.

7. Behavioral & Technical STAR Examples

Keep these bullet points handy as quick references for your STAR responses:

1. Working Together (Royal Free Hospital Collaboration)

- a. **Situation:** NIBSC needed commutability data but Royal Free's clinical lab had limited resources.
- b. **Task:** Design a collaborative protocol that minimized Royal Free's workload while gathering robust data.
- c. **Action:** Organized weekly syncs, co-designed a streamlined SOP, provided assay kits, and maintained open communication.
- d. **Result:** Completed the study on time, delivered a high-quality dataset for the WHO report, and the protocol was adopted by other labs.

2. Changing & Improving (EQA-Based Commutability Study)

- a. **Situation:** Traditional commutability studies used small sample sizes, limiting statistical power.
- b. **Task:** Expand data collection without burdening collaborators.
- c. **Action:** Proposed integrating reference material into an EQA program; negotiated agreements, drafted protocols, and trained EQA labs.
- d. **Result:** Collected 300+ data points from global labs at no extra cost; approach became a template for future projects.

3. Delivering at Pace (WHO Standardisation Deadlines)

- a. **Situation:** WHO Expert Committee required reference standards by a fixed annual deadline.
- b. **Task:** Coordinate multiple production steps, testing, and stakeholder reviews to meet the deadline.

- c. **Action:** Created a detailed Gantt chart, held weekly progress meetings, reprioritized tasks as needed, and synced with QA and production.
- d. **Result:** Delivered reference materials on schedule with zero non-conformances; received positive feedback from WHO.

4. Problem-Solving (PCR Batch Deviation)

- a. **Situation:** Cobas 6800 PCR run showed drifting Ct values, risking assay reliability.
- b. **Task:** Identify the root cause and prevent recurrence.
- c. **Action:** Quarantined the run, reviewed raw data, identified an expired master mix, and implemented a CAPA: introduced external positive run controls.
- d. **Result:** Eliminated Ct drift in future runs, improved assay reliability, and passed subsequent audits.

5. Attention to Detail (Biosafety Cabinet Certification)

- a. **Situation:** Routine BSC airflow certification sticker had expired—potential risk of compromised containment.
- b. **Task:** Prevent any safety or compliance breach.
- c. **Action:** Halted work immediately, notified divisional resource manager to rectify, and performed post-service airflow validation.
- d. **Result:** Prevented potential exposure, maintained zero safety incidents, and reinforced team awareness of certification schedules.

8. Questions to Ask the Interviewers

(Asking informed questions demonstrates genuine interest and helps you understand the role and team.)

1. “What does a typical day look like for a Biotechnologist 1 at the Slough site?”

– Follow-up: “Which processes or product lines would I be most involved with in my first month?”

2. “How is success measured for someone in this role over the first 3–6 months?”

– Follow-up: “What key milestones or metrics do you track?”

3. “What training and mentorship, developmental programs support new hires at Lonza?”

– Follow-up: “Is there a structured onboarding curriculum or departmental rotation?”

4. “How does the Slough facility integrate single-use bioreactors with traditional stainless-steel systems?”

– Follow-up: “What challenges do you face when scaling processes between SUBs and SSBs, and how are they addressed?”

5. “Can you share any current process improvement initiatives underway at Slough?”

– Follow-up: “How do cross-functional teams typically collaborate to implement these improvements?”

9. Final Tips & Reminders

• Dress Code:

- Business-casual: smart trousers or skirt, collared shirt or blouse, closed-toe shoes.
- Avoid loud patterns; keep it professional and comfortable for lab boots or covers if required.

• Material Checklist:

- Multiple copies of your CV
- Invitation email and parking confirmation
- Photo ID (passport or driver’s license)
- Notepad and pen for taking notes

– Any requested forms or paperwork

- **Arrival Logistics:**

– Target arrival by 12:45 PM to allow time for parking (Space 16) and check-in at B234 reception.

– Familiarize yourself with directions; account for potential traffic on Bath Road.

- **During the Interview:**

– Speak clearly and confidently; maintain eye contact.

– Verbally walk through your thought process during the practical assessment (Lonza values transparency).

– Emphasize safety, GMP compliance, and documentation at every opportunity.

– Pace yourself—if you need clarification on a question, it's better to ask than to guess.

- **Post-Interview Follow-Up:**

– Send personalized thank-you emails within 24 hours to each interviewer (Tara Gorman, Gemma Lyon, Ashley Davidson).

– Reference a specific point from your conversation to reinforce your enthusiasm and fit.

You Are Ready to Succeed!

With over 15 years of hands-on experience in GMP/ISO labs, a solid track record of technical achievements, and this comprehensive preparation guide, you are well-equipped to shine on June 5th. Highlight your GMP expertise, problem-solving mindset, and passion for Lonza's mission. Good luck!